

Navigating Health Insurance Options in Minnesota: A Guide for ARM

Federal Health Insurance Programs

Medicare

Overview:

- Federal health insurance primarily for those 65+ or younger individuals with disabilities.

Parts of Medicare:

- Part A: Hospital insurance
- Part B: Medical insurance
- Part C: Medicare Advantage (private insurance alternative)
- Part D: Prescription drug coverage

Extra Help Program:

- Assists with Medicare Part D costs for those with limited income/resources.

How to Apply:

- <https://www.ssa.gov/benefits/medicare/>
- Call 1-800-772-1213

Medicaid (Medical Assistance - MA in Minnesota)

Overview:

- Health coverage for eligible low-income adults, children, pregnant women, seniors, and disabled individuals.

Eligibility:

- Based on income and household size (up to 138% FPL for adults).

How to Apply:

- <https://www.mnsure.org>
- Call 1-855-366-7873
- County or tribal human services office

Minnesota State Health Programs

MinnesotaCare

Overview:

- Health care program for low-income Minnesotans who do not qualify for MA.

Eligibility:

- Minnesota resident
- Income/asset guidelines
- Not enrolled in Medicare Parts A or B

How to Apply:

- <https://www.mnsure.org>
- Call 1-855-366-7873

Hennepin County Health Programs

Hennepin Health

Overview:

- County-based program integrating medical, behavioral health, and social services.

Eligibility:

- Hennepin County resident
- Meets MA income/asset guidelines

How to Apply:

- <https://www.mnsure.org>
- Call 612-596-1300

Supplemental Insurance

Medigap (Medicare Supplement Insurance)

- Fills gaps in Original Medicare.
- Must have Medicare A & B.
- Does not cover prescriptions (need Part D).
- Purchase from private insurance companies.

Employer or Retiree Plans

- Often include Rx, dental, vision.

MA & MinnesotaCare Wraparound

- Dual-eligible patients may have MSHO or SNBC plans.

Other Supplemental Plans

- Hospital indemnity, critical illness, standalone dental/vision/hearing.

Helpful Resources:

- Senior LinkAge Line: 1-800-333-2433, <https://mnaging.org>
- <https://www.medicare.gov>
- MN Department of Commerce: <https://mn.gov/commerce>

VA Health Care Benefits

Overview:

- Provided through VA Medical Centers/clinics.

Eligibility:

- Service length, discharge status, income, disability rating.

How to Enroll:

- <https://www.va.gov/health-care/how-to-apply/>
- Minneapolis VA: 612-725-2000
- Phone: 1-877-222-8387

VA Priority Groups:

- Determines copays, access, services covered.

VA + Other Insurance:

- Can and often should have both VA + Medicare/MA.
- VA is not creditable for Part D (unless using VA pharmacy).
- MA can cover services not provided by VA.

Special Programs:

- Dental (limited), Community Care, behavioral health, services for women veterans.

Helpful Resources:

- Hennepin County Veterans Services: 612-348-3300, <https://www.hennepin.us/veterans>
- MN Dept. of Veterans Affairs: <https://mn.gov/mdva/>

Application Assistance

MNsure Navigators:

- Free help with MA, MinnesotaCare, other programs.
- <https://www.mnsure.org/help/find-assister/index.jsp>

Community Action Partnership of Hennepin County:

- In-person MNsure help: 612-348-8858, <https://caphennepin.org/mnsure-assistance/>

Renewals:

- Annual renewal required for Minnesota Health Care Programs.
- Report income/household changes promptly.

Quick Tips for ARM/Community Paramedic Guidance

- Ask each patient if they served in the military.
- If yes, ask if they're enrolled in VA health care.
- Connect non-enrolled veterans to County Veterans Services.
- Educate dual-eligible patients on using both systems properly.
- Encourage low-income veterans to enroll in VA care.
- Be aware of VA Community Care referral pathways.

For more tools: contact MNsure Navigators, Senior LinkAge Line, Hennepin County Veterans Services, or local CVSO.